# Empirical Environmental Economics Course - Guidelines for group assignment

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## Assignment

- Each group is assigned a topic, which consists in a set of questions based on a published paper related to the course topic and its data.
- The assignment consists in reading the paper, using a statistical software (R or Stata) to analyze the data and answer the specific questions, and writing up a short research paper

## Deadline

The paper in a pdf format and the code(s) used for the analysis should be sent to me (marion.leroutier@ensae.fr) by **Friday 8 May, midnight.**

## Group formation and topic assignment

- 2 (exceptionally 3) people in each group
- Groups are formed in the first lecture based on expressed preferences
- After the first lecture, I will send a folder for each topic with the dataset and material

## Paper structure:

Although shorter, the paper should have the same structures as a published empirical research paper, with these four sections:

- **Introduction:** summarizing the interest of the research questions extensions, the related literature and your findings
- **Empirical strategy:** part where you should write down the equations of what you are estimating with a description of the variables, and describe the data used for estimation (including a table of summary statistics)
- **Results:** Discuss and interpret all the results from your extensions. When comparing results across different specifications, discuss which specification you think is most likely to bring unbiased results and be interpreted in a causal way.
- **Discussion and conclusion:**
    - What do the extensions add to the main paper?
    - And focusing on the main paper:
        - What do you find interesting in the paper? What are its limitations?
        - Do you think its results would generalize to the more recent period and to other countries? (external validity)
        - What should future research investigate?

## Paper format

- 5 pages maximum, excluding tables, figures and bibliography
- If Latex is used, use a 1.5 spacing and a 10pt font size. If Word is used, use a font size of 11.